

CASE ID: 201803710002a

EPISODE NAME: Section 232 Retaliation

2018/03/08 - Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: United States (2)

Issue: Retaliation (16)

Final Outcome: Ongoing

Summary:

On 2018/03/08, China threatened the Trump administration after it announced plans to move forward with global steel and aluminum tariffs. After the tariffs were imposed on 2018/03/23, China imposed retaliatory tariffs on 2018/04/02. The episode is ongoing.

Narrative:

On 2018/03/08, China said the country would “firmly defend its legitimate rights and interests” after the United States announced it would impose global steel and aluminum tariffs on 2018/03/01.¹²

After the US tariffs went into effect on 2018/03/23, China retaliated on 2018/04/02 with tariffs it claimed were proportional to American measures.³ The Chinese retaliatory tariffs covered \$2.4 billion worth of US products, including aluminum waste and scrap, pork, fruits and nuts.⁴

The episode began a larger campaign of economic coercion. The two countries eventually traded four lists of tariffs in addition to the steel and aluminum tariffs.

This episode is ongoing.

¹ “China, Japan, South Korea bristle over Trump’s tariffs.” *CNBC*, 8 March 2018.

<https://www.cnn.com/2018/03/08/china-resolutely-opposed-trumps-steel-aluminum-trade-tariffs.html>

² Swanson, Ana. “Trump to Impose Sweeping Steel and Aluminum Tariffs.” *New York Times*, 1 March 2018.

<https://www.nytimes.com/2018/03/01/business/trump-tariffs.html>

³ “China imposes retaliatory tariffs on US products.” *Al Jazeera*, 2 April 2018.

<https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2018/4/2/china-imposes-retaliatory-tariffs-on-us-products>

⁴ Zhiyao, Lu and Jeffrey Schott. “How Is China Retaliating for US National Security Tariffs on Steel and Aluminum?” *Peterson Institute for International Economics*, 9 April 2018.

<https://www.piie.com/research/piie-charts/2018/how-china-retaliating-us-national-security-tariffs-steel-and-aluminum>